

Appendix B. Scoring rubric and questionnaire administration

This appendix summarises the scoring rules and administration procedures used for the questionnaire-based assessment in the trial.

1. Scope of the questionnaire

The questionnaire comprised risk-related behavior or etiologic clue identification items, diagnosis items, and triage items. Diagnosis items and triage items shared the same case stem but were scored independently.

2. Scoring rules for risk-related behavior or etiologic clue identification items

Respondents were required to identify and enter the single most relevant high-risk behavior or etiologic clue based on the information provided in the case stem. Responses that did not follow the task instruction were considered invalid. Blank responses, responses consisting only of numbers, or clearly irrelevant free-text entries were treated as invalid questionnaire responses and were excluded from analysis.

3. Scoring rules for diagnosis items

Each diagnosis item had one predefined correct diagnostic target. Respondents were required to provide one and only one diagnosis. Multiple diagnoses entered for a single item were scored as incorrect. Clinically equivalent disease names or synonymous expressions were accepted, provided that they matched the intended diagnosis defined in the answer key. Thus, more than one wording could be acceptable, but only one diagnosis could be submitted for scoring.

4. Scoring rules for triage items

Respondents were required to select one and only one response from the four predefined triage categories: "Self-care," "Within a week," "Within a day," and "Emergency." Multiple selections for a single item were scored as incorrect. Responses that did not correspond to one of the four predefined triage categories were also scored as incorrect.

5. Relationship between diagnosis and triage scoring

Diagnosis and triage items were scored separately even when linked to the same case stem. A correct diagnosis did not imply a correct triage decision, and vice versa.

6. Questionnaire administration and supervision

Questionnaire completion was conducted under standardised supervision. All facilitators received training before trial implementation and were required to follow uniform procedures. Facilitators were not permitted to disclose, suggest, or hint at the correct answers. Their role was limited to explaining how to complete the questionnaire according to the item instructions, how to use the mini-program for information retrieval when applicable, and how to supervise completion in a standardised manner.

7. Key principles used for scoring

Item type	Valid response	Incorrect / invalid response
Risk / Etiology	One most relevant high-risk behavior or etiologic clue	Blank, number-only, irrelevant text, or answers not following the stem instruction

Diagnosis	One diagnosis only; synonymous disease names acceptable if clinically equivalent	Multiple diagnoses for one item
Triage	One choice only from the four predefined categories	Multiple choices or free text outside the four categories